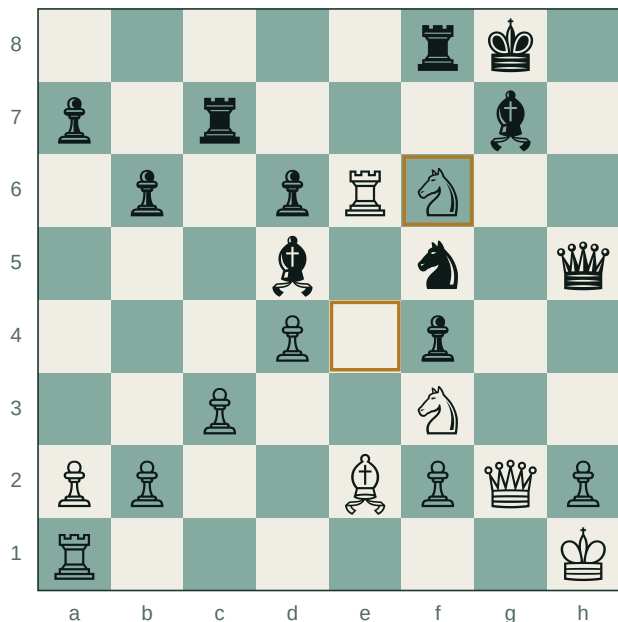


Kingside attacks: Black, move 23

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 23.Nf6+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Rxf6 24. Rxf6 Nh4 25. Nxh4 Bxg2+ 26. Nxg2 Qxe2

23...Rxf6 The rook captures the knight on f6. Recorded reply: **24.Rxf6**.

24...Nh4 The knight moves from f5 to h4. From h4 it attacks queen on g2 and knight on f3. Recorded reply: **25.Nxh4**.

25...Bxg2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on g2. Recorded reply: **26.Nxg2**.

26...Qxe2 The queen captures the bishop on e2.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: pawn on h2.